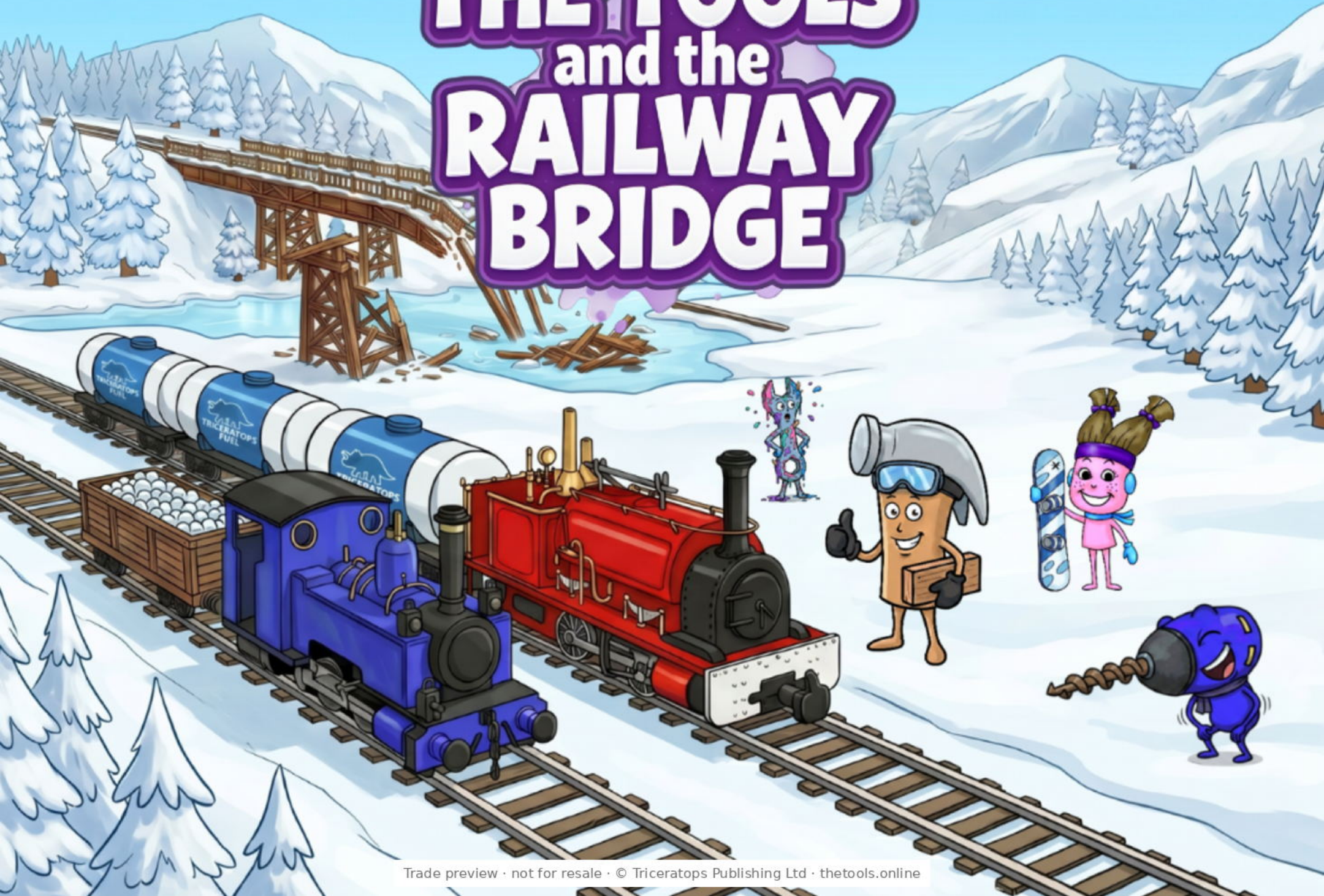


THE TOOLS and the RAILWAY BRIDGE



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The Tools and The Railway Bridge



By Mike Bannerman



It was a very busy day at Redstone Quarry. The tools were building brand new train wagons. Hector was measuring everything twice. Roxie was checking every panel was perfectly straight. Diesel had done things properly so far. JJ the Jackhammer was ready and waiting for Patrick Pickaxe to load up and head out.

Patrick was on his sandwich break. Patrick was always on his sandwich break.





Down by the frozen lake there was a sign. It said **DO NOT FEED THE BEAVERS**. Sam the Spanner read it very carefully. Sam pointed at it several times. Paz already had a carrot. The beaver looked at the carrot. Paz looked at the beaver. Sam looked at Paz. “Don’t” said Sam. Paz fed the beaver the carrot.



Then another beaver arrived. Then another. Then quite a lot more. They wanted more carrots.



Paz scrambled up onto the pier — the big thick wooden leg that holds the bridge up. The beavers had other ideas. They started chewing!

CRAAAAACK — SPLASH!
The whole thing came down!
Beavers scattered everywhere!
Paz clung on tight to what was left. Sam grabbed his radio. “We have a situation!”





Back at the Quarry, Roxie's radio crackled. The bridge was down. The trains had to be stopped before anyone tried to cross it. Hector grabbed his keys while Roxie was already strapping on her snowboard.



“I’ll beat you there on my snowboard!” said Roxie. Hector was sure his fast off-roader would win this one. He grinned, started the engine and put his foot down!









Roxie went straight down.
No road. No path. Just fresh
snow and pine trees and the
whole mountain in front of
her. She slid left and right,
launched off rocks and
ducked under branches.

She was going very fast. She was also having a great
time! Far below, Hector's headlights bounced along the
winding mountain road. Roxie hit the biggest snow
ramp on the whole mountain and launched off the edge

— and her parachute opened! Nobody was expecting that. Not Sam. Not the beavers. Not Patrick, who had finally left the quarry and was making his way along the track toward the bridge. Roxie floated down perfectly over Twin Falls and landed right beside the broken bridge. She put out her stop sign for Patrick to see.



Patrick stopped his train just in time! Right in front of the gap where the bridge used to be! “ Phew! ” said Patrick. “ That was a close one! ” Roxie smiled.





The tools found Patrick a safe spot to wait while repairs began. No problem at all — time for a sandwich! Patrick sat down and got out a fresh one, very much looking forward to it. He had no idea the beavers were watching.

Before he could take a single bite, the greedy beavers grabbed it and ate it all!



Further up the line, the snow was coming down heavily and trains were getting stuck all along the track.



Wayne Wrench was already out in his loader, scooping great mounds of snow off the tracks and making a very satisfying job of it.

Paz had taken the monster truck out and was pulling stuck trains free, one by one! Wayne watched from his loader. Paz hadn't caused a single bit of trouble! It felt too good to be true.





Back at the quarry, Diesel had finished the wagons and loaded them with tins of paint for the next train to collect. While drinking his coffee, he noticed something.

“Did I fit the brakes?” Nobody answered. Nobody was there.

The wagons started rolling — faster and faster! Diesel ran after them. “IT’LL BE FIIIIINE!”

he shouted. It was not fine at all!







Back at the broken bridge, Charlie Chainsaw arrived in his yellow logging truck, loaded up with timber. The tools were ready. Shamus rumbled in with his purple truck and the big excavator on the back. Hector had his tape measure. Wayne had his welder. JJ had enough voltage to light up all of Twin Falls.



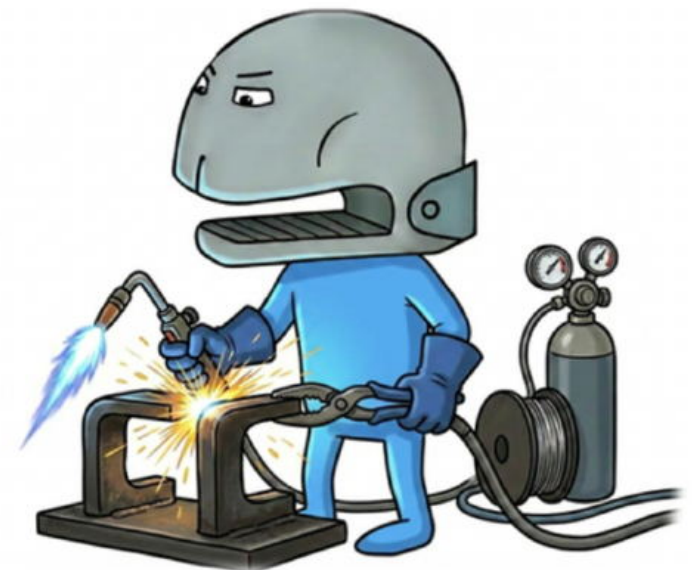
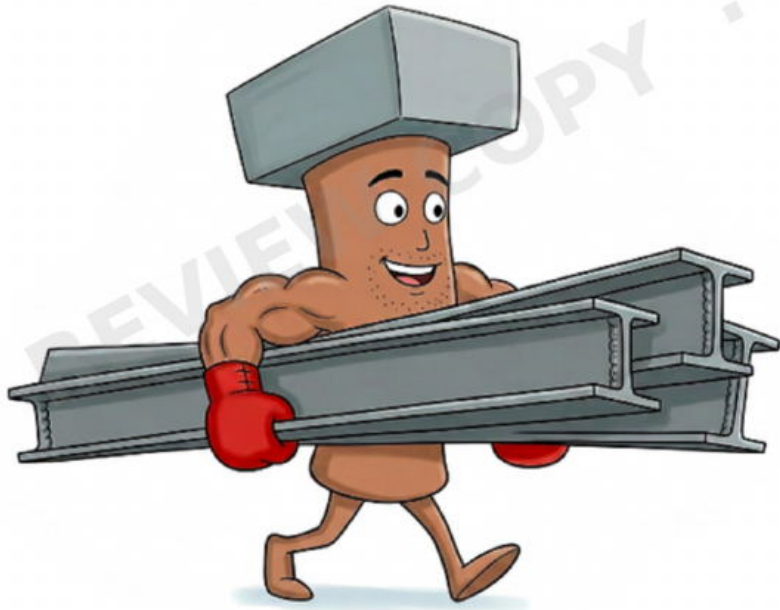


Everyone got to work. Hector measured. Wayne welded. JJ smashed things that nobody else would even attempt.





Paz felt very helpful indeed. Shamus was using the excavator. Unlike any other shovel, Shamus does not like to dig. He is very lazy





The new bridge was finished. Stronger than ever — timber, steel and concrete. Charlie's yellow truck sat proudly underneath it.



Patrick's train began to cross. Everyone held their breath. The bridge held perfectly. Everyone cheered! Then from somewhere up the mountain came a rumbling. Getting louder. Getting closer. It was Diesel — in his runaway wagons — rolling at full speed!



Diesel's wagons came flying round the corner and smashed straight into the back of Patrick's train on the brand new bridge! SPLAT! Paint tins flew everywhere! The bridge was covered! The tools were covered! The beavers were covered! Patrick was covered! "I CAN EXPLAIN!" shouted Diesel. Everyone looked at Diesel. Then at the paint. Then at Diesel again.



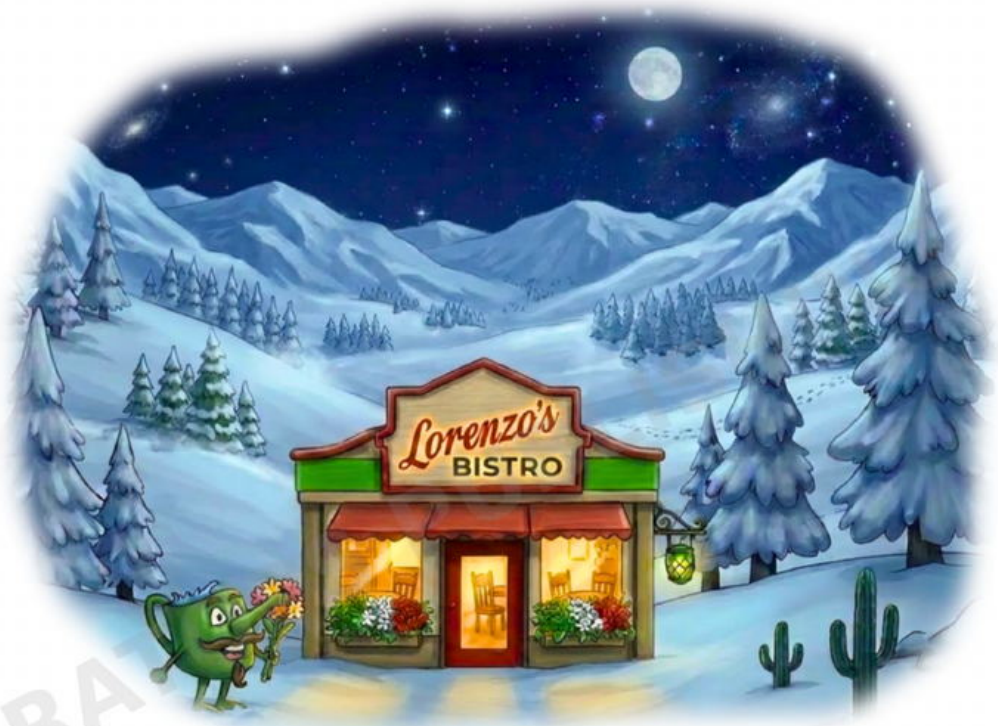
Wayne was covered in paint and not impressed at all! Billy the Bucket appeared with a sponge, looking very cheerful. Wayne just stood there, dripping. But soon the train was gleaming clean again, heading back through the snowy mountains to the quarry. Job done.

Finally!



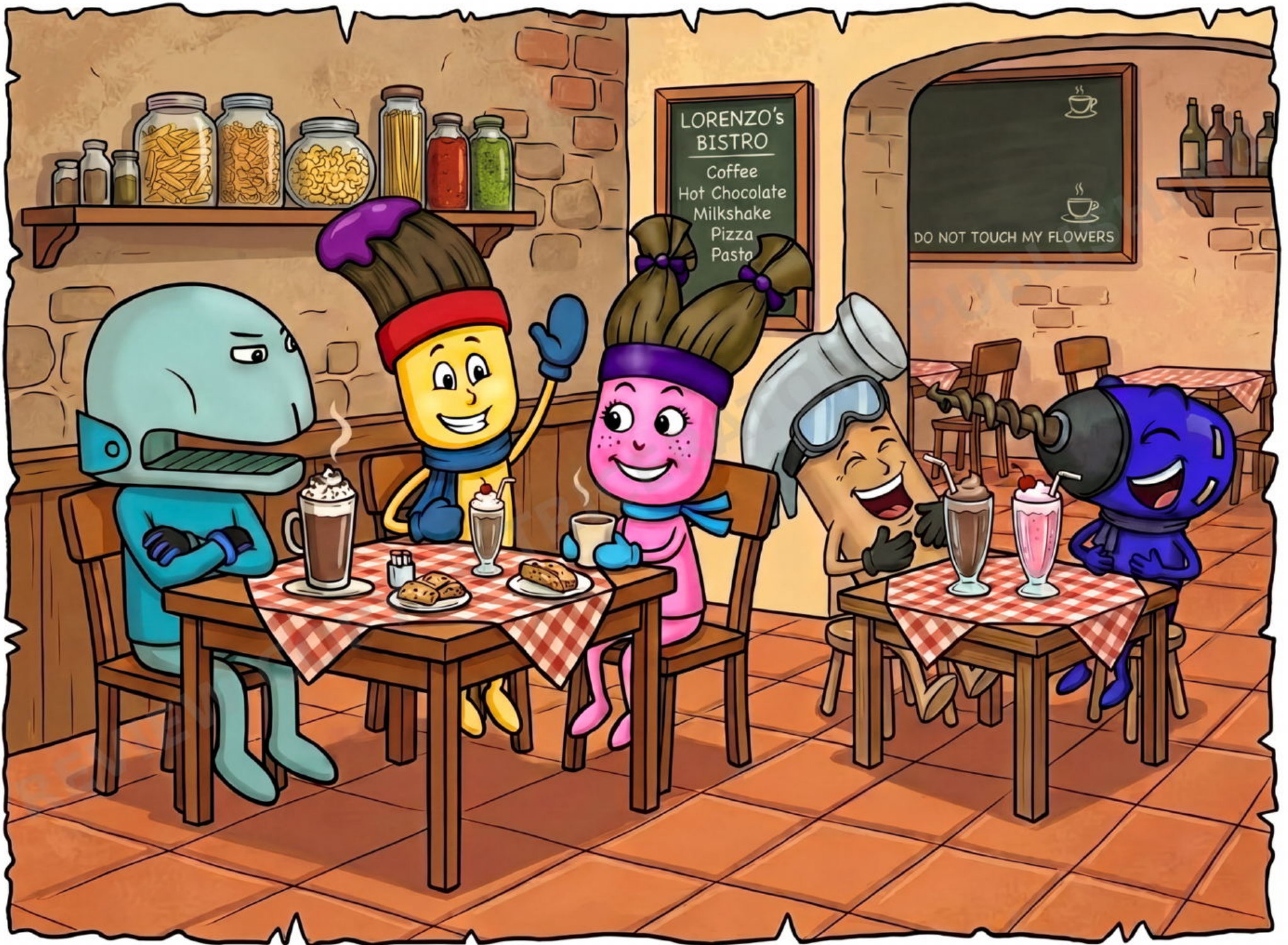


The whole crew squeezed in to Lorenzo's Bistro, exhausted and very happy. Lorenzo was in his kitchen making his famous chocolate milkshakes and — remarkably — he was smiling.



Lorenzo did not often smile when the tools were around. Today had gone well. Everything was calm. Everything was perfect. Lorenzo hummed quietly to himself and reached for the storeroom door.





The beavers had found the storeroom! Lorenzo stood in the doorway, furious. They looked very comfortable, munching their way through his best pasta! Steam started puffing out of Lorenzo's spout! Outside, the tools were still celebrating the bridge rebuild, having no idea at all.



Back at Redstone Quarry, Patrick's train, and the two quarry trains all stood clean and ready on the tracks — wagons loaded with rubble, coal and fuel for their next journeys out. The quarry was quiet. The work was done. Another day in Twin Falls sorted out, fixed up and put right — just the way the tools like it.



THE END



Found the secret word?



Somewhere in this book is a secret word. Only those who have read every page will find it!



Scan the QR code below to unlock your FREE surprise from Twin Falls!



The idea of The Tools came to me when I was 7 years old. I was doodling on a piece of paper and drew a saw with a face and arms and legs. Soon, more tool characters were created and my mum, dad and close family would always encourage me to make something of it.

Years later, I used the same idea and stories and created these children's books. With a Christian upbringing, I've always had a strong relationship with God and I truly believe He blesses us with ideas and things we might not even think to use. So for every idea or story that I write or have written, to God be the glory. Please find the inspirational Bible quote at the back of each of my books and may God bless each and every one of you.





**" Do to others what you would
have them do to you. "**

Matthew 7:12

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